

WELDING FUMES TOOLBOX TALK

Control welding-fume and metal-vapour exposure at source.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Control inhalation of metal fumes, gases and particulates generated during welding at source.

KEY HAZARDS

1  Inhalation of metal fumes.	2  Stainless-steel welding fumes.	3  Zinc oxide from galvanised materials.	4  Toxic fumes from painted surfaces.
5  Fume accumulation in restricted areas.	6  Inadequate ventilation.	7  Incorrect respiratory-protection	8  Long-term chronic exposure.

CRITICAL POINTS TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

01 Inhalation of metal fumes.	02 Stainless-steel welding fumes.	03 Zinc oxide from galvanised materials.
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REMEMBER — SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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FIELD REQUIREMENTS AND VERIFICATION

Control inhalation of metal fumes, gases and particulates generated during welding at source.

SERNEM FIELD 01
FIELD VERIFICATION 1
Material identified

SERNEM FIELD 02
FIELD VERIFICATION 2
Coating checked

SERNEM FIELD 03
FIELD VERIFICATION 3
LEV available

SERNEM FIELD 04
FIELD VERIFICATION 4
LEV operating

VERIFICATION BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Material identified | ☐ Coating checked |
| ☐ LEV available | ☐ LEV operating |
| ☐ Ventilation adequate | ☐ Respiratory PPE suitable |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- What metal are we welding today?
- Is the surface painted or coated?
- Is the LEV operating correctly?

FIELD APPLICATION



Control welding-fume and metal-vapour exposure at source.

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES

1. ELIMINATE / REDUCE THE RISK

Identify the base metal and coatings. • Keep the welder's head outside the fume plume. • Confirm LEV operation before starting.

2. ENGINEERING & PHYSICAL CONTROLS

Safely remove unsuitable coatings. • Use suitable respiratory protection where required. • Stop work if exposure controls are ineffective.

3. WORK METHOD & FIELD CONTROLS

Use local exhaust ventilation. • Verify filter selection and fit testing.

4. PPE, VERIFICATION & SUPERVISION

Provide adequate general ventilation. • Monitor the atmosphere in confined areas.

CRITICAL WARNING



Team, welding fumes will not be controlled by PPE alone. We will first provide effective LEV and ventilation. We will confirm the material and coating and use suitable respiratory protection where required.

SITE CHECKLIST — BEFORE STARTING WORK

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Material identified | ☐ Coating checked |
| ☐ LEV available | ☐ LEV operating |
| ☐ Ventilation adequate | ☐ Respiratory PPE suitable |
| ☐ Fit test valid | ☐ Filter correct |
| ☐ Atmosphere checked | ☐ Crew briefed |



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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
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12			